

Proposed Policy for New Mentors/Volunteers for Academy

Every September, our club welcomes a new group of children aged 5+ who bring energy, enthusiasm and excitement to the St. Pats academy. These children represent the future of our club, with the potential to play through all ages, grades and all codes. Alongside them come parents/guardians whose support, involvement, volunteering and commitment are essential to the continued growth and development of the club, both on and off the field.

To ensure a safe, positive and supportive environment for all these children, and parents/guardians and in line with GAA policy and guidance, the St. Pats Executive has outlined the following process for the new academy annually.

Potential Mentors/volunteers can be identified and recommended by GPO, other mentors, juvenile chair or any executive member. The process is as below;

Action	Responsible	Timeframe
Potential Mentors/volunteers are identified .	GPO/Juvenile Chair/other Mentors	Sept ongoing
Membership: Mentor must be a registered member* of the GAA, LGFA, or Camogie Association. Mentor then creates a foireann account https://gmssupport.zendesk.com/hc/en-gb/articles/360017355999-Setting-up-a-Foireann-account	Club Registrar/New Mentor/volunteer	Sept
Vetting: Mentor must have satisfactory Garda Vetting completed before commencing the role. https://www.gaa.ie/the-gaa/child-safeguarding-and-protection/vetting	Club Childrens Officer/New Mentor/ Volunteer	Sept
Safeguarding: Mandatory attendance at safeguarding 1 for mentor/volunteer. Foireann Account linked to Tobar (GAA learning Platform) https://gmssupport.zendesk.com/hc/en-gb/articles/9391382443292-Linking-Tobar-LMS-account-to-Foireann	Club Childrens Officer/ New Mentor/Volunteer	Nov. /Jan
Mentors Qualifications: Foundation course	GPO /New Mentor	

**each new mentor/volunteer will be given free membership for Sept –Jan , thereafter they will pay own membership or cease acting as mentor.*

All new mentors will be reviewed and ratified by club executive annually

(brought by CCO to agreed exec meeting)

Policy Agreed & Endorsed by St Pats Executive;

Chairperson

Date

Review date Sept 2028. Policy owner Club Childrens Officer.

Supplementary Info to be provided to New Mentors/Volunteers

Code of Behaviour (Underage) and Child Safeguarding Policy Statement

<https://www.gaa.ie/api/pdfs/image/upload/gh96alunyhh5qa9bczoo.pdf>

Maintaining appropriate levels of behaviour in our work with children and young people
Young Players, Coaches, Supporters, Parents/Guardians, Referees and Clubs.

<https://www.gaa.ie/api/pdfs/image/upload/tgt2wj098wpkini58pfd.pdf>

Creating a Foireann account

<https://gmssupport.zendesk.com/hc/en-gb/articles/360017355999-Setting-up-a-Foireann-account>

GAA Garda Vetting Info for all applicants

<https://www.gaa.ie/the-gaa/child-safeguarding-and-protection/vetting>

Childrens Officer must meet applicant in person and complete forms

Applicants will receive an email from the Garda NVB with an invitation for vetting. This should be completed immediately. Please watch for this email as it sometimes ends up in junk/spam. If not completed within 30 days the application is cancelled by the Garda NVB.

GAA Safeguarding

Creating a Tobar account

<https://learning.gaa.ie/CreateAccount>

Linking Tobar, GAA (learning management system) account to Foireann

<https://gmssupport.zendesk.com/hc/en-gb/articles/9391382443292-Linking-Tobar-LMS-account-to-Foireann>

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